Samuel Liu

Email: samuelliu@as.edu.tw | Website: samuelkliu.com

Appointments

Postdoctoral Fellow — August 2026–Present
Institute of Political Science, Academia Sinica (IPSAS) — *Taipei, Taiwan*

Predoctoral Fellow — January 2026–May 2026
Institute for America, China, and the Future of Global Affairs (ACF), Johns Hopkins SAIS — *Washington, D.C.*

Education

Cornell University — 2026
Ph.D. Government — *Ithaca, NY*

- Field: International Relations (major), Comparative Politics (minor)
- Dissertation: "Three Experiments on International Security in U.S.-China-Taiwan Relations"
- Committee: Jessica Chen Weiss (Chair), Sarah Kreps, Thomas Pepinsky

Cornell University — 2023
M.A. Government — *Ithaca, NY*

University College London — 2019
MSc Security Studies, Merit — *London, UK*

University of Hong Kong — 2018
BSocSc Politics and Public Administration, First Class Honours — *Hong Kong*

Publications

1. Dafoe, Allan, Samuel Liu, Brian O'Keefe, and Jessica Chen Weiss. 2022. "Provocation, Public Opinion, and International Disputes: Evidence from China." *International Studies Quarterly* 66 (2): sqac006.
2. Chan, Zenobia T., Samuel Liu, and Kai Quek. 2021. "Audience Costs and the Credibility of Commitments." In *Oxford Bibliographies* (*International Relations*). Oxford University Press.

Work in Progress

1. "Don't Try for a Second Mile: Credible Threats and Assurances in U.S.-China Coercion"
2. "Repairing Interconnected Credibility in Security Commitments: Evidence from Taiwan"
3. "Deterrence by Assurance? Domestic Costs of Counter-Coercion Strategies in Taiwan"
4. "Tactical Shift and Violence Perception" (with Polly Chan)

Teaching

Course Instructor

GOVT1101 Politics of Dissent in Hong Kong (Writing seminar).
Syllabus available upon request. — Fall 2022

Teaching Assistant

GOVT3837 The Cold War (Writing seminar with Matthew Evangelista) — Spring 2023
GOVT2897 Human Rights at War (Writing seminar with Matthew Evangelista) — Spring 2022
GOVT3121 Crime and Punishment (with Joseph Margulies) — Fall 2021
GOVT3443 Southeast Asian Politics (with Thomas Pepinsky) — Spring 2021
GOVT3557 Exceptionalism Questioned: America and Europe (Writing seminar with Peter Katzenstein) — Fall 2020

Research Experience

Research Assistant to Jessica Chen Weiss 2020–2021
Cornell University *Ithaca, NY*
Research Assistant to Kai Quek 2017–2018
University of Hong Kong *Hong Kong*

Fellowships, Awards, and Grants

External
Replication + Novel Survey Experiment Competition, Northwestern University (1,500 survey respondents and coauthorship opportunity) May 2026
Expense Support, Institute for Humane Studies ($1,500) 2026
World Politics and Statecraft Fellowship, Smith Richardson Foundation ($10,000 in 2025–2026; $7,500 in 2024–2025) 2024–2026
Doctoral Fellowship, Chiang Ching-kuo Foundation (one-year fellowship) 2024–2025
China-U.S. Scholars Program Conference Grant, Institute of International Education ($4,000) 2024
U.S. Foreign Policy Dissertation Grant, Stand Together Trust ($5,000) 2023
***Internal* (*only competitive awards listed*)**
Lee Teng-hui Fellowship, East Asia Program 2025–2026
Research Travel Grant, Graduate School ($1,600) 2025
Lee Teng-hui Fellowship, East Asia Program (*declined*) 2024–2025
Andrew Kohut Fellowship, Roper Center for Public Opinion Research Summer 2024
Small Research Grant, Qualitative & Interpretive Research Institute ($1,150) 2023

Presentations and Talks

Rebecca B. Morton Conference on Experimental Political Science: 2026.
International Security and Public Opinion Workshop, Academia Sinica: 2025.
Empirical Studies on Conflict (ESOC): 2025.
American Political Science Association (APSA): 2019, 2024, 2025, 2026.
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA): 2018, 2024, 2025.
International Studies Association (ISA): 2026.
Lecture Series at Institute of Political Science, Academia Sinica: March and October 2025.

Service

Reviewer: *International Studies Quarterly*, *Journal of Conflict Resolution*, *Journal of Peace Research*, *Journal of East Asian Studies*, *Conflict Management and Peace Science*, *International Interactions*, *British Journal of Politics and International Relations*, *Foreign Policy Analysis*

Skills

Languages: Cantonese (native) and Mandarin (fluent)
Software: R, Stata, LaTeX, Qualtrics, Git/GitHub
Fieldwork: Taiwan (2023–2024)